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(12) **United States Plant Patent**
van den Haak

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(54) **PHLOX PLANT NAMED ‘IFPHLFM’**

(50) Latin Name: *Phlox paniculata*
Varietal Denomination: **IFPHLFM**

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patent is extended or adjusted under 35
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(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./320**
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USPC Plt./320
See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named
‘IFPHLFM’, characterized by its compact and uniformly
mounded plant habit; moderately vigorous to vigorous
growth habit; freely branching habit; dark green-colored
leaves; freely flowering habit; flowers that are intense red
purple in color; and good container and garden performance.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical designation: *Phlox paniculata*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘IFPHLFM’.

CROSS-REFERENCED TO CLOSELY RELATED
APPLICATIONS

Title: Varieties of *Phlox* Plants
Applicant: Jelle van den Haak
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BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Phlox* plant, botanically known as *Phlox paniculata*,
typically grown as a container and garden *Phlox*, hereinafter
referred to by the name ‘IFPHLFM’ and disclosed in U.S.
Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 62/764,553.

The new *Phlox* plant is a product of a planned breeding
program conducted by the Inventor in Andijk, The Nether-
lands. The objective of the breeding program is to create new
vigorous *Phlox* plants with numerous attractive flowers.

The new *Phlox* plant originated from a cross-pollination
of a proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata* identified as
code number 9009-05, not patented, as the female, or seed,
parent with a proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata*
identified as code number 047-11-K013-01, not patented, as
the male, or pollen, parent in August, 2013. The new *Phlox*
plant was discovered and selected as a single plant from
within the progeny of the stated cross-pollination in a
controlled nursery environment in Andijk, The Netherlands
in July, 2014.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Phlox* plant by cuttings
in a controlled environment in Andijk, The Netherlands

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since September, 2017 has shown that the unique features of
this new *Phlox* plant are stable and reproduced true to type
in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The new *Phlox* plant has not been observed under all
possible combinations of environmental conditions and cul-
tural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with
variations in environmental conditions such as temperature
and light intensity without, however, any variance in geno-
type.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of
‘IFPHLFM’. These characteristics in combination distin-
guish ‘IFPHLFM’ as a new and distinct *Phlox* plant:

1. Compact and uniformly mounded plant habit.
2. Moderately vigorous to vigorous growth habit.
3. Freely branching habit.
4. Dark green-colored leaves.
5. Freely flowering habit.
6. Flowers that are intense red purple in color.
7. Good container and garden performance.

Plants of the new *Phlox* and the female parent selection
differ primarily in flower color as plants of the new *Phlox*
have red purple-colored flowers whereas plants of the
female parent selection have light purple-colored flowers.

Plants of the new *Phlox* and the male parent selection
differ primarily in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Phlox* are not as compact as plants of
the male parent selection.
2. Plants of the new *Phlox* have larger flowers than plants
of the male parent selection.

Plants of the new *Phlox* can also be compared to plants of
Phlox paniculata ‘Barfourteen’, disclosed in U.S. Plant Pat.

No. 12,605. In side-by-side comparisons, plants of the new *Phlox* and 'Barfourteen' differ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Phlox* have larger flowers than plants of 'Barfourteen'.
2. Plants of the new *Phlox* and 'Barfourteen' differ in flower color as flowers of plants of the new *Phlox* are lighter red purple in color than flowers of plants 'Barfourteen'.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying photographs illustrate the overall appearance of the new *Phlox* plant showing the colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photographs may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the colors of the new *Phlox* plant.

The photograph on the first sheet is a side perspective view of a typical flowering plant of 'IFPHLFM' grown in a container.

The photographs on the second sheet are close-up views of a typical inflorescence (upper photograph) and typical leaves (lower photograph) of 'IFPHLFM'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations and measurements describe plants grown during the summer in 17-cm containers in an outdoor nursery in Heerhugowaard, The Netherlands and under cultural practices typically used in commercial *Phlox* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures ranged from 10° C. to 25° C. and night temperatures ranged from 4° C. to 15° C. Plants were pinched five weeks after planting and were 15 weeks old when the photographs and description were taken. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 2015 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Phlox paniculata* 'IFPHLFM'.

Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata* identified as code number 9009-5, not patented.

Male, or pollen, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata* identified as code number 047-11-K013-01, not patented.

Propagation:

Type.—By terminal cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About 12 days at temperatures about 20° C.

Time to initiate roots, winter.—About 16 days at temperatures about 20° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.—About 36 days at temperatures about 18° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, winter.—About 42 days at temperatures about 18° C.

Root description.—Medium in thickness, moderately fibrous; close to 158B to 158C in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizer type and formulation, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Freely branching; dense.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Herbaceous perennial; broadly upright and compact plant habit; overall shape, broadly and short inverted triangle; moderately vigorous to vigorous in growth habit and moderate growth rate.

Plant height, soil level to top of foliar plane.—About 21.7 cm.

Plant height, soil level to top of floral plane.—About 25.6 cm.

Plant width (spread).—About 27.3 cm.

Lateral branches.—Quantity: Typically a single primary branch and about ten secondary branches per plant. Length: About 14.2 cm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Internode length: About 2.3 cm. Strength: Strong. Aspect: Upright to about 40° from vertical. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; moderately glossy. Color: Close to 144A to 144B; color becoming closer to 143B to 143C with development; at the petiole attachment, strongly tinged with close to N186C.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Opposite, simple.

Length.—About 9.9 cm.

Width.—About 4.1 cm.

Shape.—Elliptic to obovate; moderately carinate.

Apex.—Apiculate.

Base.—Truncate.

Margin.—Entire; very finely serrate, serrations are inconspicuous.

Texture and luster, upper surface.—Smooth, glabrous; moderately rugose; slightly glossy.

Texture and luster, lower surface.—Smooth, glabrous; moderately rugose; matte.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper surface: Close to 144A. Developing leaves, lower surface: Close to 144B. Fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Slightly darker than between NN137A and 147A; venation, close to N144A. Fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 137C; venation, close to 145B.

Petioles.—Length: About 4 mm. Diameter: About 2.5 mm by 3 mm. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Color, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144B.

Flower description:

Flower type and flowering habit.—Single rotate and salverform flowers arranged in compound terminal panicles; flowers face upright to outwardly; panicles roughly hemispherical in shape; freely flowering habit with about 165 flowers developing per inflorescence and about 1,000 flowers developing per plant during the flowering season.

Fragrance.—Moderately fragrant; sweet, pleasant.

Natural flowering season.—Plants begin flowering about 15 weeks after planting; long flowering period, plants flower continuously throughout the summer in The Netherlands.

Flower longevity.—Flowers last about ten days on the plant; flowers not persistent.

Flower buds.—Height: About 2.4 cm. Diameter: About 5 mm. Shape: Oblanceolate. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; slightly glossy. Color: Close to N80A; tube, close to N77B; developing calyx, close to 144C, distally, close to 200A.

Inflorescence height.—About 10.1 cm.

Inflorescence diameter.—About 11.4 cm.

Flower diameter.—About 2.8 cm.

Flower depth.—About 2.5 cm.

Flower throat diameter.—About 3 mm.

Flower tube length.—About 1.7 cm.

Flower tube diameter.—About 3 mm.

Petals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single whorl; petals fused at the base into a narrow tube;

free parts slightly imbricate. Length (including tube):

About 3.1 cm; 55% of the petal is fused. Lobe width:

About 1.3 cm. Lobe shape: Spatulate. Lobe apex:

Obtuse. Margin: Entire; slightly undulate. Texture

and luster, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; velvety;

matte. Texture and luster, lower surface: Smooth,

glabrous; slightly velvety; slightly glossy. Texture,

throat: Smooth, glabrous; moderately velvety. Tex-

ture, tube: Densely pubescent. Color: When opening,

upper surface: Between 61A and 71A; towards the

throat, close to 71B. When opening, lower surface:

Close to 72C. Fully opened, upper surface: Between

71B and N74A; towards the throat, close to N74B;

venation, similar to lamina colors; color does not

change with development. Fully opened, lower sur-

face: Between 77B and 77C; venation, similar to

lamina colors; color does not change with develop-

ment. Throat: Close to N66A; venation, close to

N66A. Tube: Close to 77B; venation, close to 77B.

Sepals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single

whorl, fused towards the base; calyx, campanulate.

Length: About 7 mm; 30% of the sepal is fused.

Width: About 1.5 mm. Shape: Lanceolate. Apex:

Narrowly apiculate. Margin: Entire; not undulate.

Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces:

Smooth, glabrous; slightly glossy. Color: When

opening, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144C;

distally, close to 200A; towards the margins, close to

186B. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Close

to 144C strongly tinged with between N186C and 200A; towards the margins, close to 186B; venation, close to N199A.

Peduncles.—Length, terminal peduncles: About 6.3 cm. Diameter, terminal peduncles: About 2.5 mm. Aspect, primary peduncles: Erect. Aspect, secondary peduncles: About 40° from vertical. Strength: Strong. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; moderately glossy. Color: Close to 144A.

Pedicels.—Length: About 4 mm. Diameter: About 1 mm. Angle: About 20° from the peduncle axis. Strength: Moderately strong. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; moderately glossy. Color: Close to 146C slightly tinged with close to 200D.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: Typically five. Filament length: About 1 mm. Filament color: Close to N155A. Anther size: About 1.75 mm by 1 mm. Anther shape: Narrowly oblong. Anther color: Close to 159D. Pollen amount: Scarce. Pollen color: Close to 160B. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 1.8 cm. Style length: About 1 cm. Style color: Close to 146D. Stigma size: About 1.5 mm by 2 mm. Stigma shape: Cleft, three-parted. Stigma color: Close to 150D. Ovary color: Close to 143C.

Seeds and fruits.—To date, seed and fruit development have not been observed on plants of the new *Phlox*.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Phlox* have been observed to have good garden performance and tolerate rain, wind, high temperatures about 35° C. and to be suitable for USDA Hardiness Zones 6 through 10.

Pathogen & pest resistance: Plants of the new *Phlox* have been not been observed to be resistant to pathogens and pests common to *Phlox* plants.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Phlox* plant named 'IFPHLFM' as illustrated and described.

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